

SANJAYA KUMAR JENA

Talent Acquisition Lead

End-to-End Talent Acquisition | Recruitment to Onboarding | HR Business Partner

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Talent Acquisition Lead and HR Business Partner with 9+ years of experience driving full-cycle, high-volume and leadership hiring across Automotive, Electro-Mechanical, Manufacturing and Engineering R&D. Adept at scaling engineering, product, manufacturing and shop-floor teams from concept to production. Proven record closing 150+ niche R&D, manufacturing and leadership roles in a single year, building in-house recruitment engines that eliminate vendor dependency and partnering with business leaders on workforce planning, employer branding and data-driven hiring. Strong command of AI-tools, Boolean/X-Ray search and recruitment analytics, personally owning every stage of the hiring lifecycle — from sourcing and screening through offer negotiation, joining and onboarding — with staffing-vendor coordination where required.

WHAT I BRING TO THE ROLE

- Manufacturing & R&D hiring at scale: closed 150+ engineering, electro-mechanical, manufacturing, hardware, software and product roles in one year for a surgical-robotics, Nuvo AI R&D division.
- Automotive & deep-tech domain depth: hired across Automotive, Digital Transformation, Embedded, Firmware, FPGA/RTL, Motion Control, Industrial Automation, AI/ML, Computer Vision and IoT — core competencies for electro-mechanical engineering.
- Vendor-free, cost-efficient recruitment: repeatedly built in-house sourcing engines delivering 250+ hires without external agencies, improving time-to-fill by 60% and lifting offer-acceptance to 85%.
- Leadership & campus pipelines: led executive search plus IIT/NIT/IISc campus and lateral drives, hiring 50+ IIT/NIT/PhD professionals through direct sourcing.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Hiring Domains: Automotive, Electro-Mechanical, Manufacturing, Research & Development, Product, IT/Non-IT, Semiconductor, Fintech, Healthcare, Medical Devices, Surgical Robotics, Energy & Utilities, E-commerce

Recruitment Expertise: End-to-End Recruitment (Lateral & Campus), Executive & Leadership Hiring, DEI Hiring, High-Volume & Niche Hiring, Sourcing, Screening, Interview Scheduling, HR Discussions, Offer Creation & Negotiation, Onboarding & Joining Formalities.

Sourcing Skills: Advanced Sourcing, X-Ray Search, Boolean Search, GitHub Sourcing, Custom SEO Sourcing, AI Recruitment, AI-Powered Talent Acquisition

Data-Driven Hiring: Hiring Metrics, Recruitment Dashboards & Reporting, Workforce Planning & Forecasting, Talent & Recruitment Analytics, Weekly & Quarterly Reporting

Employer Branding & Pipeline: Employer Branding, Recruitment Drives, Referral Programs, Active & Passive Talent Pipeline Development, Networking Events

Onboarding & Joining: Offer Rollout, Joining Formalities, Documentation, Induction, New-Hire Handholding.

Stakeholder & Vendor Management: Business Stakeholder Partnering, Staffing-Vendor & Partner Coordination, Team Training, Process Design & Setup

Recruitment & AI Tools: LinkedIn Recruiter, Naukri, Monster, Instahyre, Shine, TimesJobs, Dice, CareerBuilder, Indeed, Cutshort, HireEZ, BizReach, SeekOut, ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude

ATS & HRMS Platforms: Workday, Taleo, Talent Recruit, GLO (GlobalLogic ATS), Zoho Recruit, BoostHR, Human Vision Software

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manager – Human Capital & Administration

May 2025 – Present

Merai NewAge Pvt Ltd. / Meril Group | Chennai, Tamil Nadu

- Independently owned end-to-end Talent Acquisition (sourcing through onboarding) for the Surgical Robotics / Nuvo AI R&D division, driving product-focused hiring, budgeting and workforce planning; closed 150+ roles in one year, including hard-to-fill positions across R&D, Manufacturing and Product functions.
- Led full-cycle recruitment and talent mapping for niche R&D roles, including competitor talent mapping.
- Hired for Product Manufacturing, Mechanical, Electrical, Hardware, Software, Motion Control and AI functions — managing sourcing, stakeholder coordination, candidate experience and pipeline management.

- Closed critical, hard-to-fill leadership and domain roles: AI/ML Lead, Computer Vision, IoT, Frontend, Data Engineer, Simulation Engineer (Unity/Unreal), FPGA, RTL, Firmware, Industrial Automation, Embedded Software/Hardware, PCB Designer, Instrumentation, EMI/EMC, Product & Industrial Designer, Mechanical CAD, Robotics Engineer, V&V, QA, Regulatory Affairs, Sales, Clinical Specialist, Supply Chain, Wire Harness and Electro-Mechanical Assembly.
- Leveraged Zoho Recruit (ATS) to manage sourcing, tracking and recruitment workflows; improved time-to-fill by 50% and lifted offer-acceptance to 85% using AI-powered sourcing (ChatGPT, Copilot, Claude) with advanced X-Ray and Boolean search.
- Partnered with leadership to forecast talent needs, design data-driven recruitment strategies and track hiring KPIs; benchmarked compensation against industry standards to strengthen offer competitiveness.
- Represented the organization as brand ambassador at career fairs and IIT Madras Research Park startup events, strengthening employer branding.
- Managed complete offer-to-onboarding for every hire — offer rollout, joining formalities, documentation, induction, orientation and new-hire handholding — ensuring smooth settlement and strong early retention.
- Designed onboarding, mentorship and interviewer-training programs, improving new-hire retention and hiring consistency across both the divisions.

Senior Talent Acquisition Consultant

Apr 2022 – May 2025

GlobalLogic, A Hitachi Group Company | Bangalore, Karnataka

- Delivered 250+ strategic hires (Japanese Bilingual & Non-Bilingual) over 3 years without external vendors, driving major cost efficiencies and strengthening in-house recruitment capability.
- Partnered with business leaders to define workforce needs and build strategic hiring plans across APAC (India, Japan, Ukraine, Australia); led end-to-end IT and Non-IT recruitment from sourcing to onboarding for critical and niche leadership roles.
- Closed high-impact roles across Automotive and Digital Transformation engineering: Product, DevOps, Cloud, AI/ML, Python, GenAI Engineers/Leads, GenAI & Cloud Architects, Data Engineering and Data Architects, plus Sales, AVP, CTO, Director, Principal, Solution/Technical Architect, Product Owner, Project and Program Manager hires.
- Built a 35-member skilled AEM team in a single quarter, contributing significantly to project success.

Talent Acquisition Partner

Mar 2021 – Apr 2022

Quess Corp Limited | Bangalore, Karnataka

- Collaborated with India & USA stakeholders to develop staffing plans and end-to-end recruitment strategies across multiple business units.
- **Deployed to FIS Global** — managed the full recruitment lifecycle via Workday across Fintech (Capital Markets, E-Access).
- **Deployed to Optum (UnitedHealth Group)** — managed the full lifecycle via Taleo across Healthcare (Optum Health, Optum Rx, Optum Insight); consistently exceeded time-to-fill and cost-per-hire targets.
- Supported ramp-ups across Java, Microsoft Technologies, Mobile (Android/iOS), Angular, React, Cloud, DevOps, UI/UX, Tableau, QA, Database Admin and Data Engineering.

Recruitment Analyst – Staffing

Mar 2019 – Sep 2020

Trigent Software Ltd. | Bangalore, Karnataka

- Managed contract staffing and bulk hiring for key accounts including Accenture, Sonim Technology and Microsoft.

Lead IT Recruiter – Staffing

Oct 2016 – Mar 2019

2Coms Consulting Pvt Ltd. | Bhubaneswar, Odisha

- Led full-cycle contract staffing for IT & Non-IT roles and managed client coordination for Accenture, Swiggy and Concentrix.

KEY ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- **Meril Group: Hired 30+ IIT, NIT and PhD senior professionals** across product divisions through direct sourcing, eliminating dependency on consultants and vendors.
- **Meril Group:** Led lateral hiring from IIT Madras, IIT Bombay, IIT Kanpur, IIT Patna, IISc Bangalore and Tier-1/2/3 engineering colleges; planned and executed job fairs and Recruitment drives.
- **GlobalLogic, A Hitachi Group Company:** Delivered 250+ strategic hires in 3 years without external vendors and built a 35-member AEM team in one quarter.
- **GlobalLogic:** “Victor of the Quarter” Award (Japan, Q2/Q3/Q4), “Helping Hand” Award, and Q1 “Most Valuable Player of the Quarter” (India).
- **Trigent Software:** Two-time Sparkler Award and one-time Bravo Award for outstanding performance.
- **2Coms Consulting:** Performance Excellence Award, Best Recruiter – Highest Revenue Achiever, Highest Target vs. Revenue Achiever, and 18 consecutive months as Performer of the Month (Red Tag).

EDUCATION

MBA – Human Resource Management, Jaipur National University (2021)

Bachelor of Arts, North Odisha University (2016)

CERTIFICATIONS

Executive Diploma in HR Management (EDHRM) – Interactive HR Spot · Certified Recruitment Professional – 2Coms · Naukri Maestro Recruiter – Naukri.com · Employer Branding – Hristech · AI-Driven Recruiting – LinkedIn · Foundations of Prompt Engineering – AWS · Artificial Intelligence Mastery – Beep App · AI Tools Workshop – be10x · AI Foundations – OpenAI · ChatGPT for HR – Great Learning · Claude 101 – Anthropic · AI-Powered Recruiter – NextInHR

LANGUAGES

English · Hindi · Odia · Bengali